

Samson Occom, sermon, Ephesians 5:20

The Occom Circle



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Date Unknown

Abstract A sermon on Ephesians 5:20 — "Giving thanks always for all things unto God" — about how, where, and when to give thanks to God.

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Ephe V. 20

Giving thanks always for all things unto God,

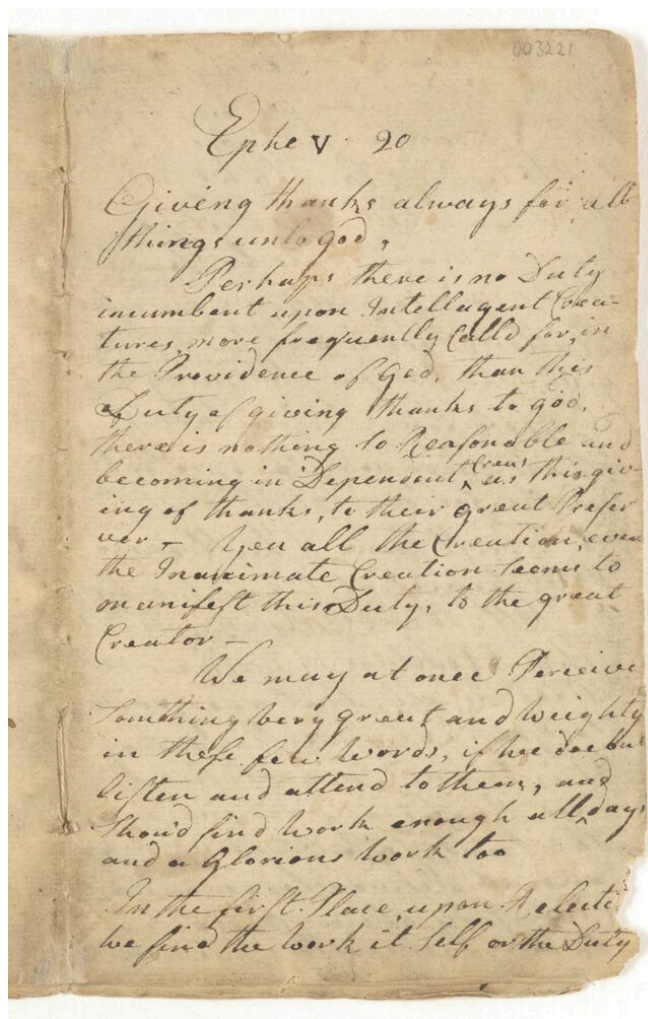
Perhaps there is no Duty incumbent upon Intelligent Creatures, more frequently Calld for, in the Providence of God, than this Duty of giving thanks to god, there is nothing So Reasonable and Becoming in Dependant & [^]Creat[^] as this giving of thanks, to their great Preferer,— Yea all the Creation, even the Inanimate Creation Seems to manifest this Duty, to the great Creator —

We may at once Perceive Something very great and weighty in these few Words, if we doe but listen and attend to them, and Shou'd find work enough all [^] day and a Glorious work too

In the first Place, upon Reflecti[^{gap: tear}]

[guess (ivys): on]

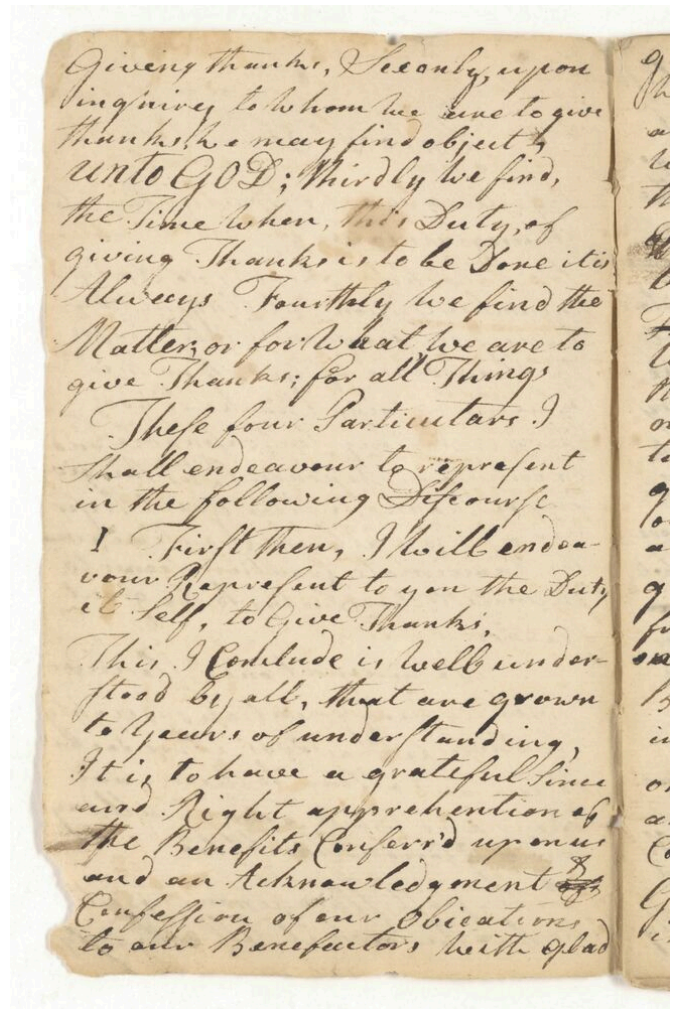
we find the work it Self or the Duty



Giving thanks, See [illegible] only, upon inquiry to whom we are to give thanks, we may find object, unto GOD; Thirdly we find, the Time when, this Duty, of giving Thanks is to be Done it is Always Fourthly we find the Matter, or for what we are to give Thanks; for all Things

These four Particulars I Shall endeavor to represent in the following Discourse

1. First then, I will endeavour Represent to you the Duty it Self, to Give Thanks, This, I Conclude is well understood by all, that are grown to Years of understanding, It is to have a grateful Since and Right apprehension of the Benefits Conferred upon us and an Acknowledgment of ^{^&^} Confession of our Obligations to our Benefactors with glad



gladness of Heart, attended
with Humility, and a Careful
and Right use of the Benefits
we Receive, even agreeable to
the Mind and Pleasures four
of Benefactors for which they

bestow^d their Bound upon us

The work Among Men, the
work of the giver is one, and
the work of the Receiver is a
nother, we are dependent Crea-
tures upon one to another, the

greatest of men Can't ^{well} live with-
out the vulgar Sort, and we,
as Sociable and Fellow Creatures,
give and receive Benefits one
from another, The giver has

[illegible:

[guess (ivys): one]

] Precept from God the great

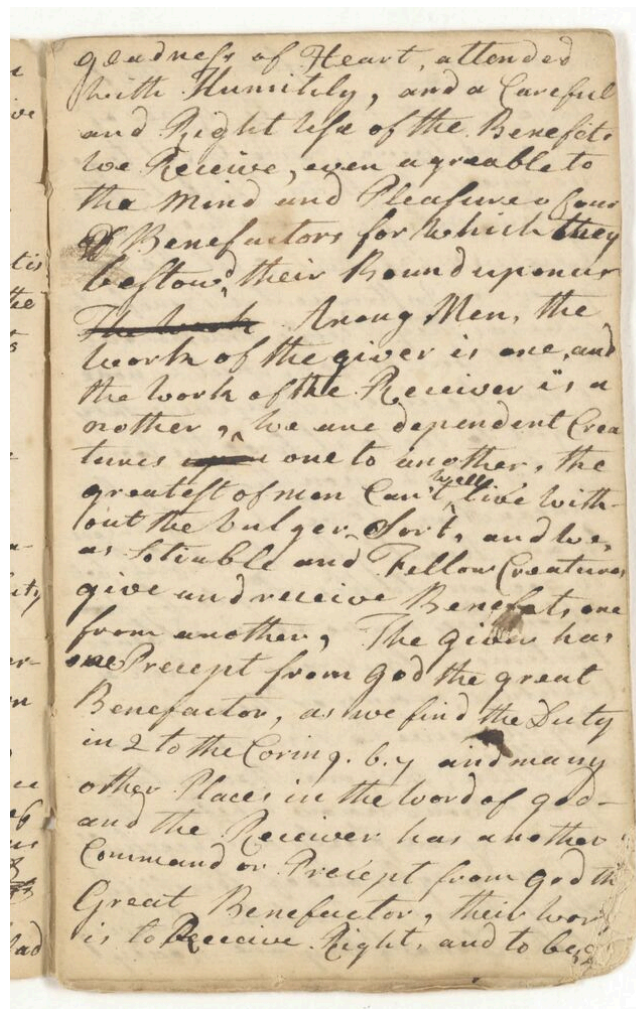
Benefactor, as we find the Duty
in 2 to the Corin 9.6.7 and many
other Places in the Word of god —
and the Receiver has another
Command or Precept from God th[^{gap: tear}]

[guess (ivys): e]

Great Benefactor, their wor[^{gap: tear}]

[guess (ivys): k]

is to Receive Right, and to be [^{gap: tear}]



be truly Thankful, in the first
Place to God the only giver of
all good things, and next to god
we are to be thankful to the
Instruments by whom we have we
Received Benefits, — let the Second
givers or Instrumental Benefactors
give as they Please whether out
a right view or not, that is none
of the Receivers Business, they
ought to See to it, to do the work
that is Lay'd upon them, by their
Benefactors, to be Truly Sincere-
ly and Heartly thankful, both
to god and to his People by wi
whom they have received bene-
factions — But man is Such a
Creature, many of them when
they Receive a Kindness from
their ^{^fellow^} Men, they are Ready to que-
ry and wou'd know whether the
giver, gave freely and Cheerfully
or Grudgingly and of Necessity,
and if they Suspect the Sincerity
[gap: tear]

[guess (ivys): of]

the Doner, they are Ready

be truly Thankful, in the first
Place to God the only giver of
all good things, and next to god
we are to be thankful to the
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Creature, many of them when
they Receive a Kindness from
their ^{fellow} Men, they are Ready to que-
ry and wou'd know whether the
giver, gave freely and Cheerfully
or Grudgingly and of Necessity,
and if they Suspect the Sincerity
of the Donor, they are Ready

to despise the Benefits and the
Benefactor, and are ^{Ready} to fling the
gifts back in the Face of the
giver with ^a Surly Countenance —
this Plainly Argues the Horrid
and Hellish Ingrati^d tue, in the
unworthy Wretch, Such cannot
be thankful to god, for they don't
Consider that all these good things
are from god, for it is he that
opens the Hands, if not the Hearts
of his People, to give to the Nee-
dy, and therefor Thanks and Praise
is his Due Chiefly; ^{and} But if
the Receiver Cant be thankful
to their fellow Creatures that have
Shown kindness to them; how Can
they be Truly thankful to god —
Isa[illegible]:

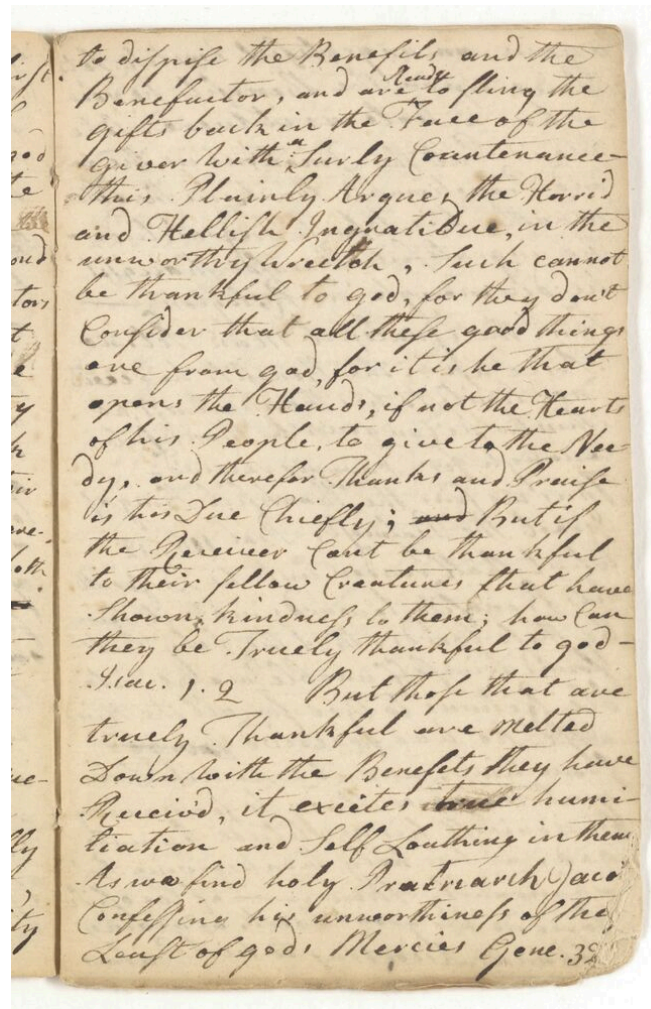
[guess (ivys): i]

]. 1.2

But those that are
truly Thankful are melted
Down with the Benefets they have
Receiv'd, it excites [illegible] true humi-
liation and Self Loathing in them
As we find holy Pratrearch Jaco[ap: tear]

[guess (ivys): b]

Confessing his unworthinefs of the
Leaft of gods Mercies Gene.32 [gap: tear]



again an ungrateful wretch. Sets
Price upon the Benefits he recei^{es}
, or has a Scale as it were, So he
wou'd Put the Donations in the one
and Propotionable thanks in the other
or rather his Blank In d^{id} gratitude —
the ungrateful Pharasee thought
he did enough in Religion ^ —

But the Grateful Man Sets no
Price upon the Benefits he recei^{es}
nor limits to his thankfulness, he
thinks he Can never be thankful
enough for Favours received —
Thus we find the ^{truly} thankful King of
Israel, the Psalmest, Psal 116. 12
what Shall ^l render unto the Ld for all
his Benefits towards me? it Seems
by these words, that the holy Psalst
found himself unable ^{to} make Suta-
ble Returns to God for all the Kind-
[illegible] nefs he had receivd [from god]
from him, and it was his Dili-
gent Search or Study to find a way
to manifest his gratitude by unto
god, as his holy thanksgiving Psa^{es}
abundantly Show, — if we oferv^e
David in his great work of giving
Thanks, According to his Psalms

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to manifest his gratitude by unto
god, as his holy thanksgiving Psa^{es}
abundantly Show, — if we observe
David in his great work of giving
Thanks, According to his Psalms

we may easily find his experimental Notice and his wise Consideration of the Benefits of god towards him and this begets a grateful Sence of the Favours of god, and that breaks forth into Publick Praises and thanksgiving — Yea upon finding himself unable to give Sufficient thanks to god for all his goodness, he Calls all Creatures both in Heaven and Earth to Join with him in his great work of giving thanks and Praise unto God; and indeed it Reasonable and Right that Dependent Creatures Shou'd be truly thankful to their up holder and only Benefactor,—

This Seems to be innate in the very Dumb Beasts of the Feald, they Manifest a kind of Gratitude to their Benefactors or Masters, by a Certain Noise, or the Motion of their Bodies,— the Fowls of the Air Mount up to wards heaven and Sing forth their Artless [gap: tear] to God, — Toads and Frogs, and all the venomous Kind, have their way of giving thanks to their Mas[gap: tear]

[guess (ivys): ters]

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yea the very Insects of the Earth
 Singing their various Notes of Praise
 to god, if all these Creatures give
 thanks and Praise to god, how
 ought Man [^]who is Endow'd [^]to give [^]for whose sake
 thanks and
 Praise to the God of heaven, it
 is Mans Beauty and Glory as well
 as Duty, to give thanks and Praise
 to Heaven, and it is his happiness
 So to do —

2. Secondly let us ☐ Consider
 the object, or to Whom we are
 or ought to give thanks, it is
 unto God, the Great Creator of
 Heaven and Earth, and the upholder
 and Governor of the Same, and the only
 Benefactor, unto him we are to give
 thanks,

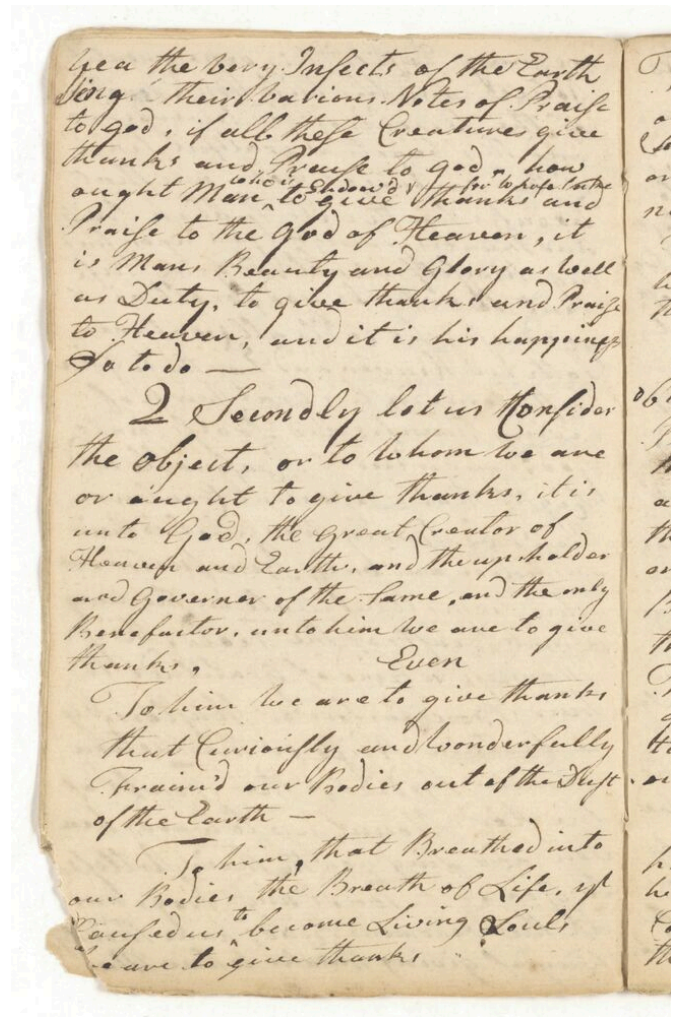
Even

To him we are to give thanks
 that Curiously and Wonderfully
 Fram'd our Bodies out of the Duft
 of the Earth —

To him, that Breathed into
 our Bodies the Breath of Life, y^t
 Caused us ^{^to^} become Living Souls
 [gap: tear]

[guess (ivys): w]

e are to give thanks.



To him we are under Infinite obligations, who Confers, not few and Small Inconsiderable Benefits up on us, but very all go^d things not at times only, but Continually

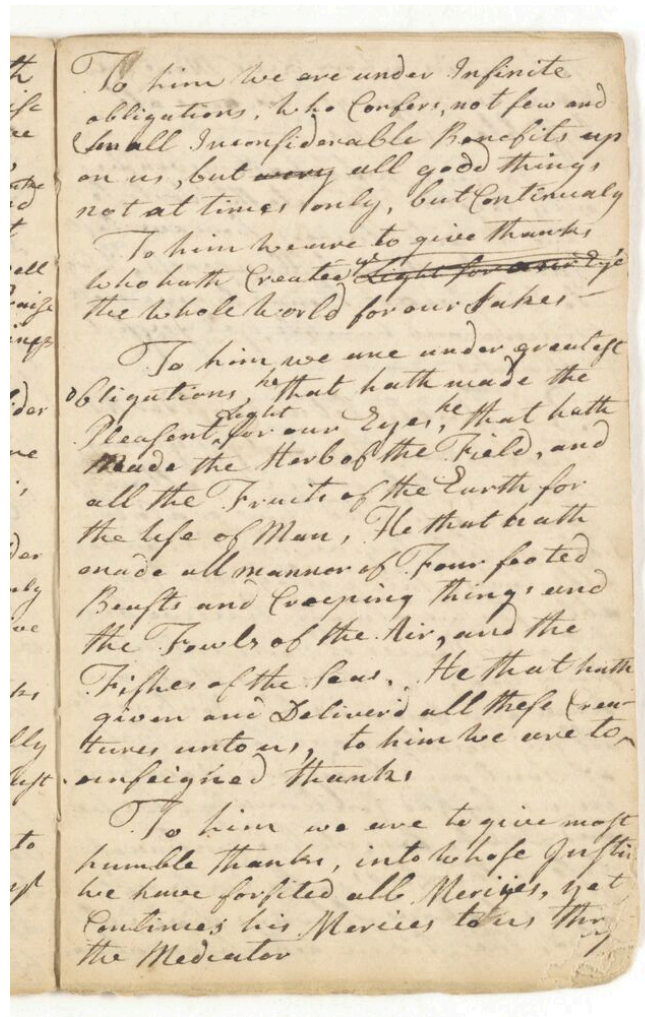
To him we are to give thanks who hath Created ^y^e^ Lights for our Eye^s^ the whole world for our Sakes —

To him we are under greateft obligations, ^{^he^} that hath made the Pleasant ^{^Light^} for our Eyes, ^{^he^} that hath Made the Herb of the Field, and all the Fruits of the Earth for the life of Man, He that hath made all manner of Four footed Beasts and Creeping things and the Fowls of the Air, and the Filhes of the Seas. He that hath given and Deliver'd all thefe Creatures unto us, to him we are to [^]unfeigned thanks

To him we are to give moft humble thanks, into whose Jufti[^{gap: tear}]
[guess (ivys): ce]

we have forfeited all Merc^yies, yet Continues his Mercies to us thr[^{gap: tear}]
[guess (ivys): o]

the Mediator



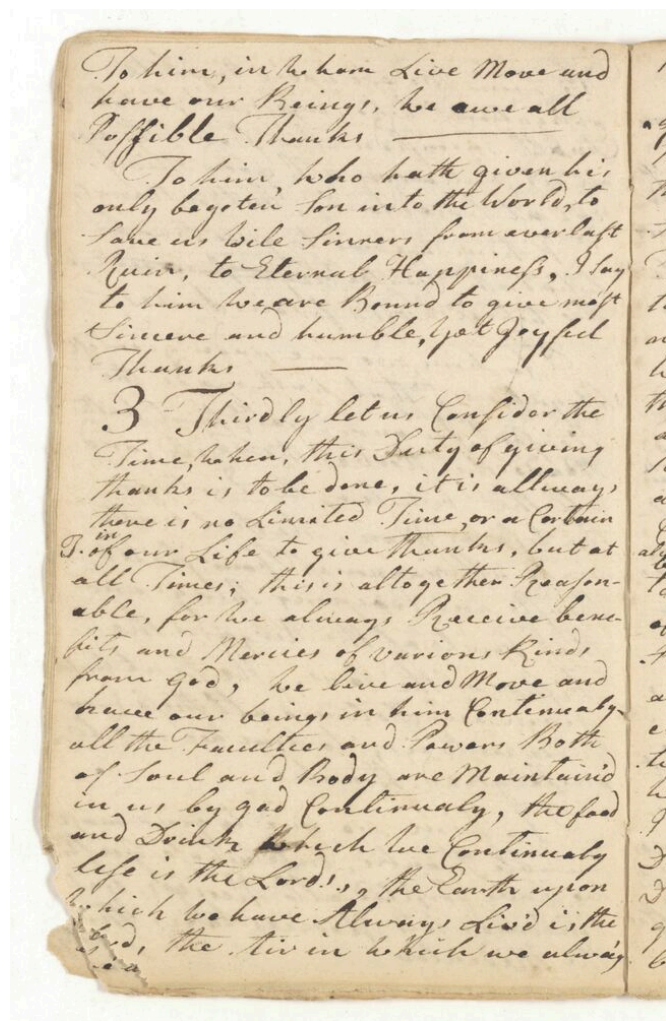
To him, in whom Live Move and
have our Beings, we owe all
Possible Thanks —

To him, who hath given his
only begotten son into the World, to
Save us vile Sinners from everlast
Ruin, to Eternal Happinefs, I Say
to him we are Bound to give most
Sincere and humble, Yet Joyful
Thanks —

3. Thirdly let us Consider the
Time, when, this Duty of giving
thanks is to be done, it is allways
there is no Limited Time, or a Certain
T. ⁱⁿ of our Life to give thanks, but at
all Times; this is altogether Reason-
able, for we always Receive bene-
fits and Mercies of various kinds
from god, we live and Move and
have our Being in him Continually—
all the Faculties and Powers Both
of Soul and Body are Maintain'd
in us by god Continually, the food
and Drink [illegible] which we Continually
Use is the Lord's, the Earth upon
which we have Always Liv'd is the
[gap: tear]

[guess (ivys): Lor]

ds the Air in which we alway^s



Breathe in is the Lords; and So in return, as we always live upon a goodness of God, So Shou'd our thanks be always to God — further this giving of thanks always may Suppose or require a thankful Fraim of Heart to God always — to have grateful Sence of the goodness of god Always, — and to have holy resolution to [illegible] go on in giving thanks to god always, as David abundantly Shows in his holy P[illegible]:

[guess (ivys): salms]

] his resolution was to Praise God — all this Time; So Shoud all ration^{al} Creatures refove, — again we Shou'd ^{always} be very Strict in attending to Certain Seafons or Perticural Times of giving Thanks to God;; whether Privet Pub^lick Privet or Secret; yea as there is no Minute of our lives empty of Mercies from god, So Shou^d we fill every Minute of our lives with thanks [illegible] to god, I [illegible] David Says I will Praise God Seven Times a Day, or give thanks Seven Times a Day, — So Shou'd we give thanks to god, not only Seven Times a Day but Seventy Times Seven

Breath in is the Lords; and So in return, as we always live upon a goodness of God, So Shou'd our thanks be always to God — further this giving of thanks always may Suppose or require a thankful Fraim of Heart to God always — to have grateful Sence of the goodness of god Always, — and to have holy resolution to go on in giving thanks to god always, as David abundantly Shows in his holy P[illegible] his resolution was to Praise God all this Time; So Shoud all rational Creatures refove, — again we Shou'd be very Strict in attending to certain Seafons or Perticural Times of giving Thanks to God;; whether Privet or Secret; yea as there is no Minute of our lives empty of Mercies from god, So Shou'd we fill every Minute of our lives with thanks to god, ~~that~~ David says I will Praise god seven Times a Day, or give thanks seven Times a Day, — So Shou'd we give thanks to god, not only seven Times a Day but seventy Times seven

I mean to have a Thankful Frain
of Heart all the Day Long —

we don't mean in all this that we ^{are}
obliged to Manifest our thankfulnes

[illegible] always in ^{one} Continued Act either
by word of Mouth or by the Posture
of the Body for this is Imposible

in the ^{Present} Settuation of our Life,
we are Necessarily Calld to other

enmediate Acts of Duty from

Day to Day, we Necessarily ^{spend} Som
time in Sleep, But this need

not, yea Can't Break off our than^k
fulnes if we are true thankful—

—As a Wife Man, is a Wife Man,—
always whether he Sleeps or wakes
whether a broad or at home, he

is Still the Same [illegible] Wife Man—

So a thankful Man is always
So —

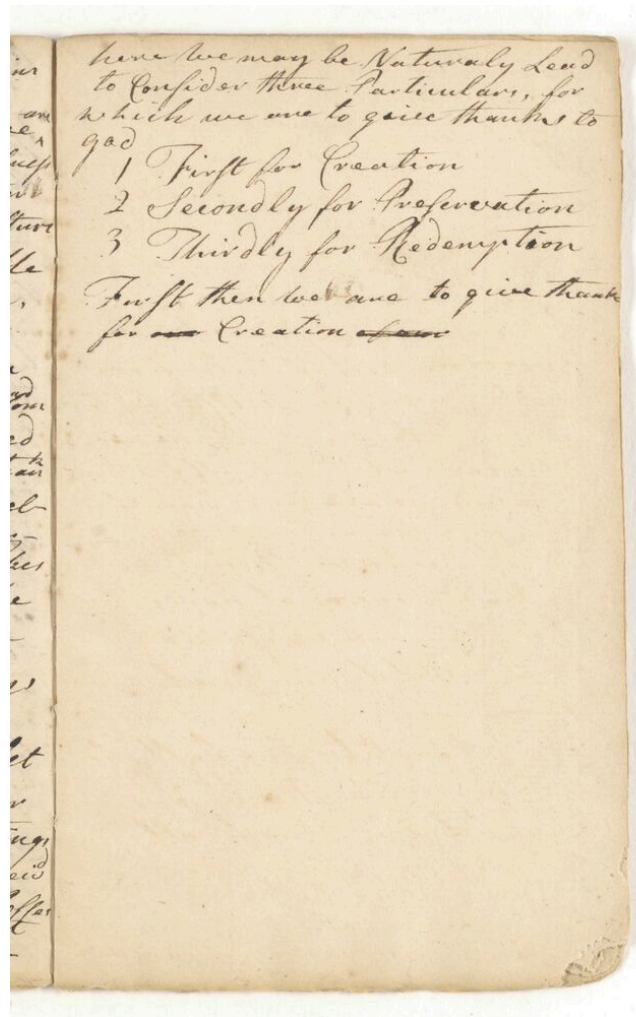
4. Fourthly and lastly let
us Consider the Matter of our
thankfulnes. It is for all things
for Every thing that we have Receiv^d
and any thing that we now Posses
and Enjoy, and for all things y^t
we ^{for} ^{hope} to Receive hereafter—

I mean to have a Thankful Frain
of Heart all the Day Long —
We don't mean in all this that we
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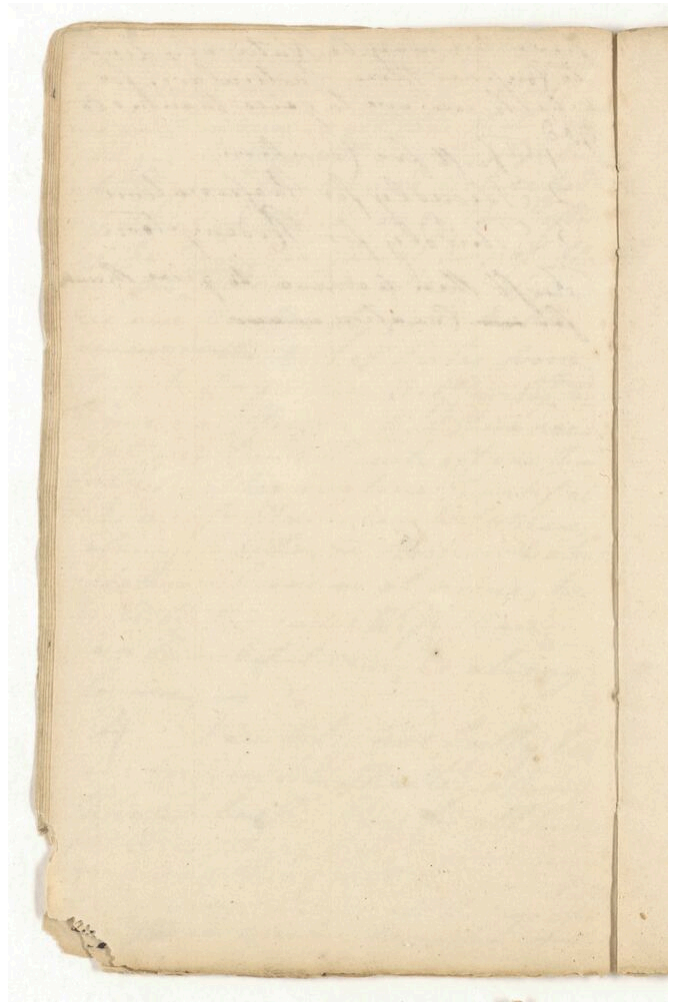
here we may be Naturally Lead
to Consider three Particulars, for
which we are to give thanks to
god

1. Firft for Creation
2. Secondly for Prefervation
3. Thirdly for Redemption

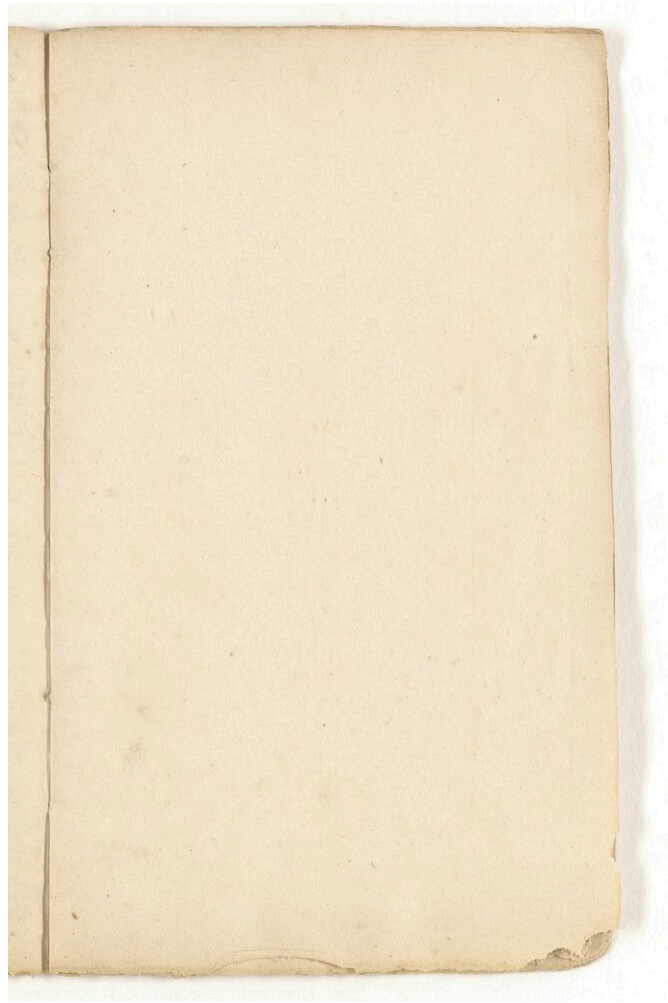
Firft then we [illegible] are to give thanks
for [our] Creation [of our]



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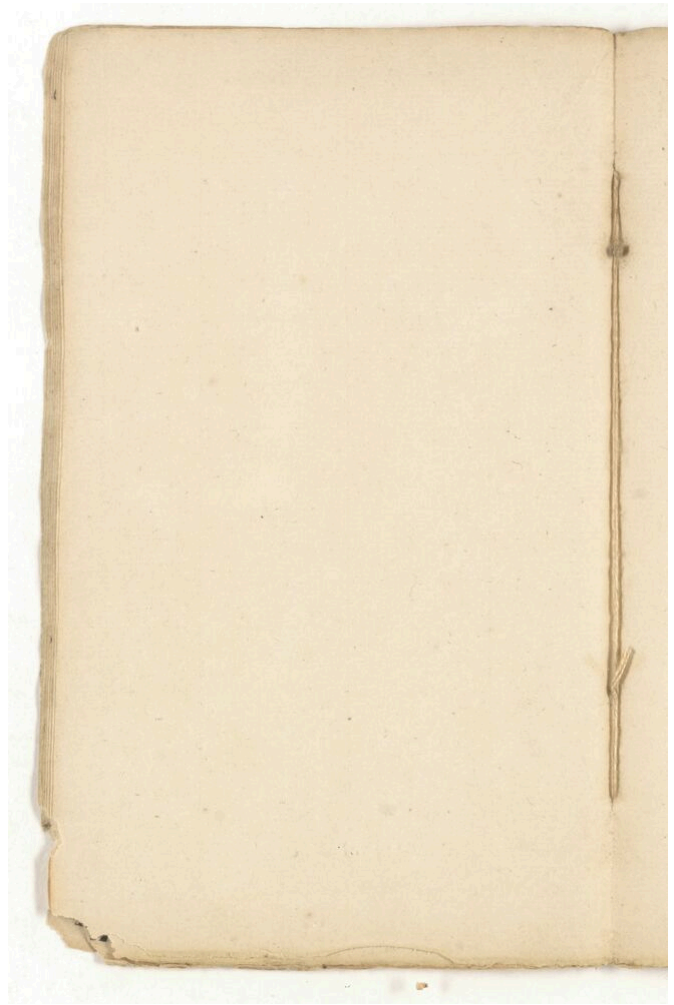


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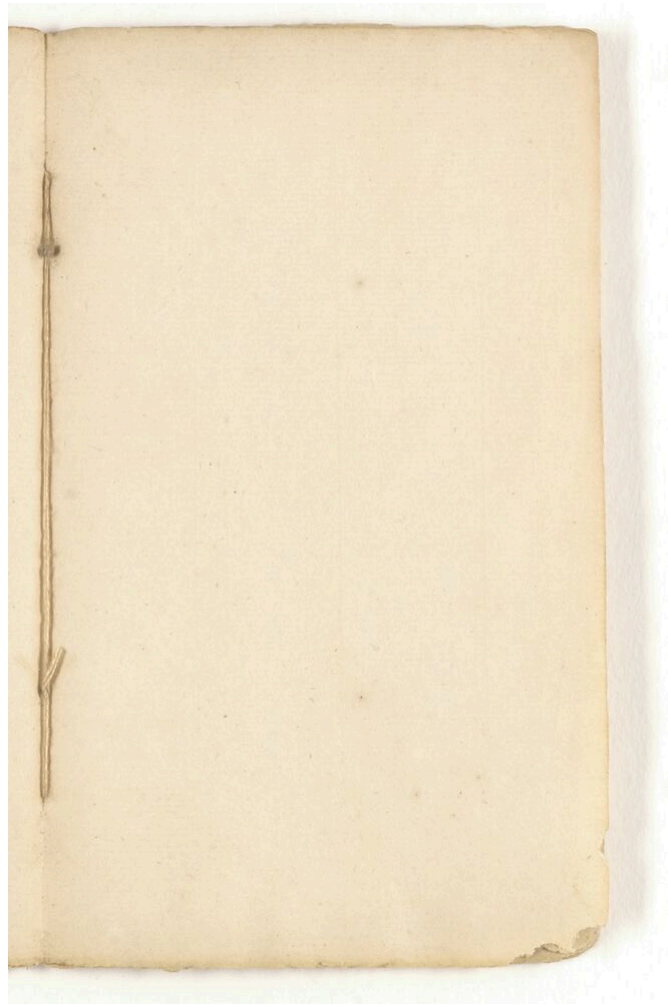
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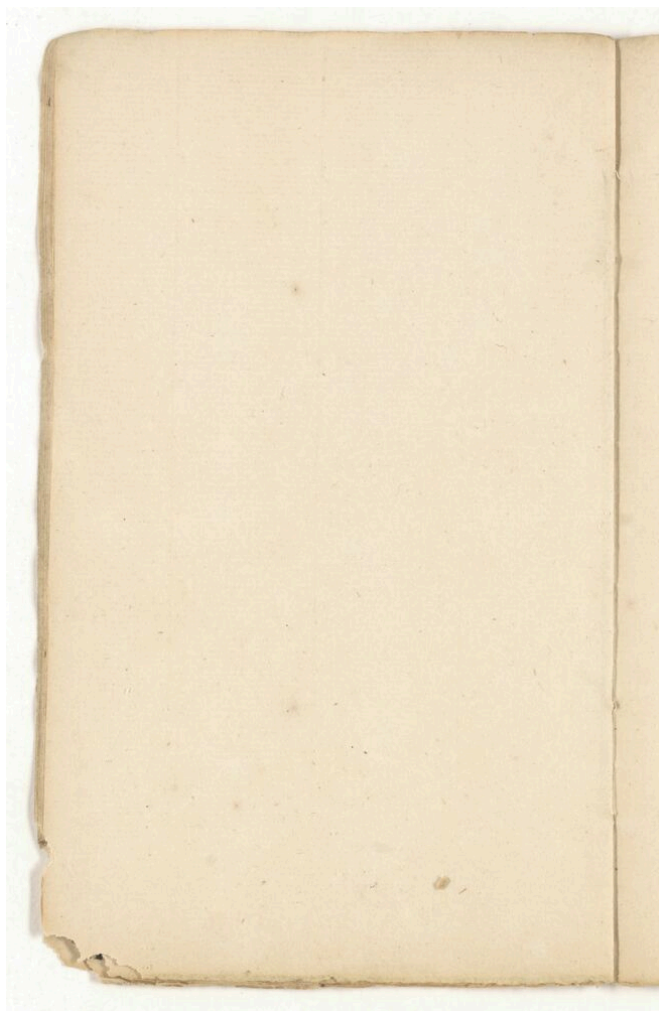


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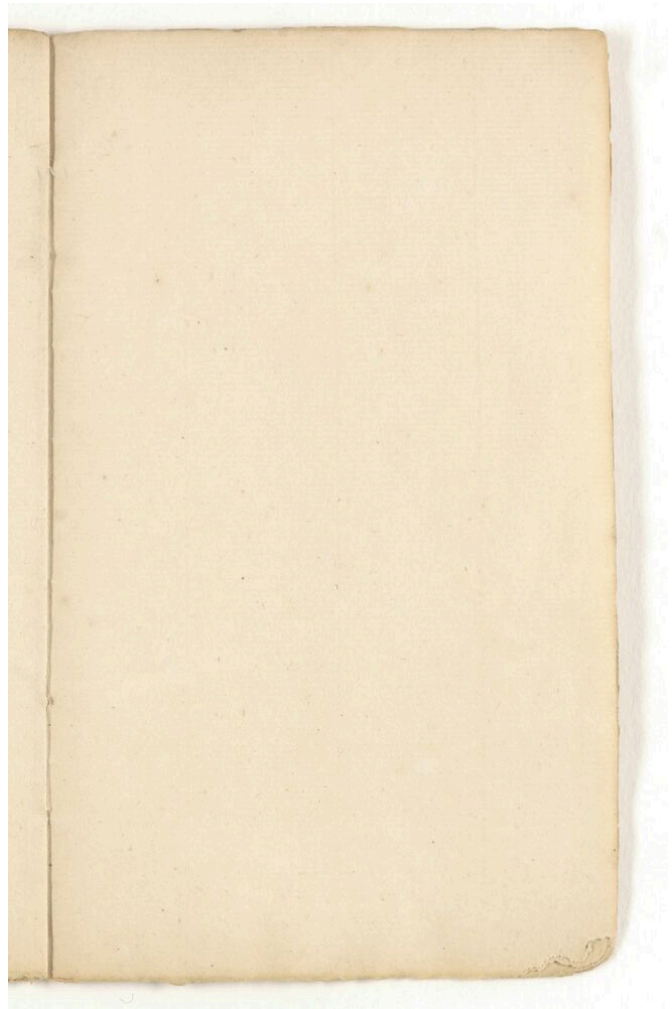
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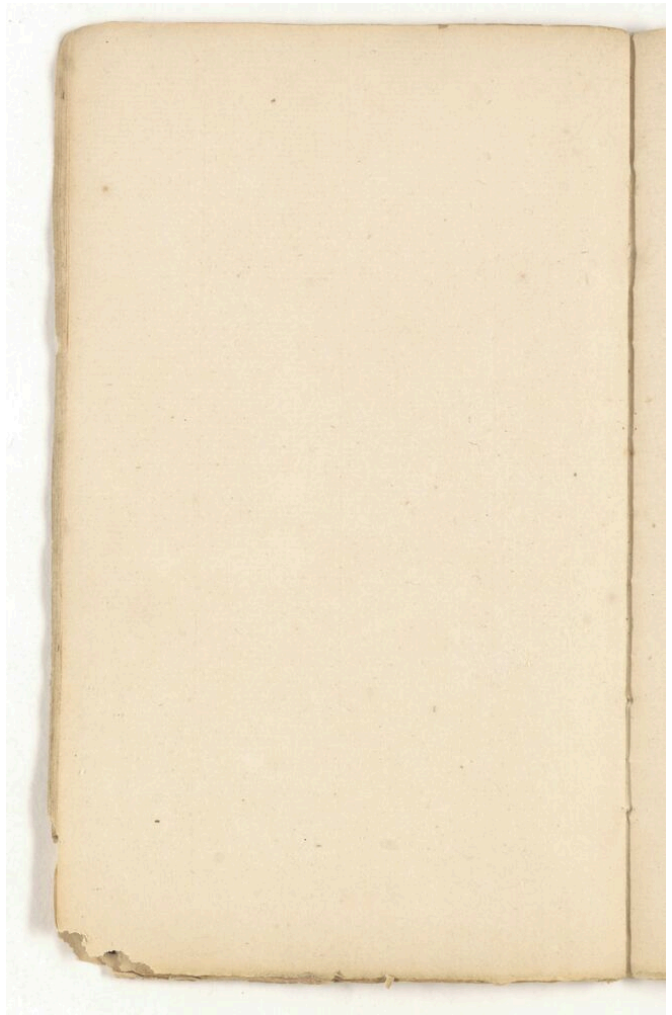
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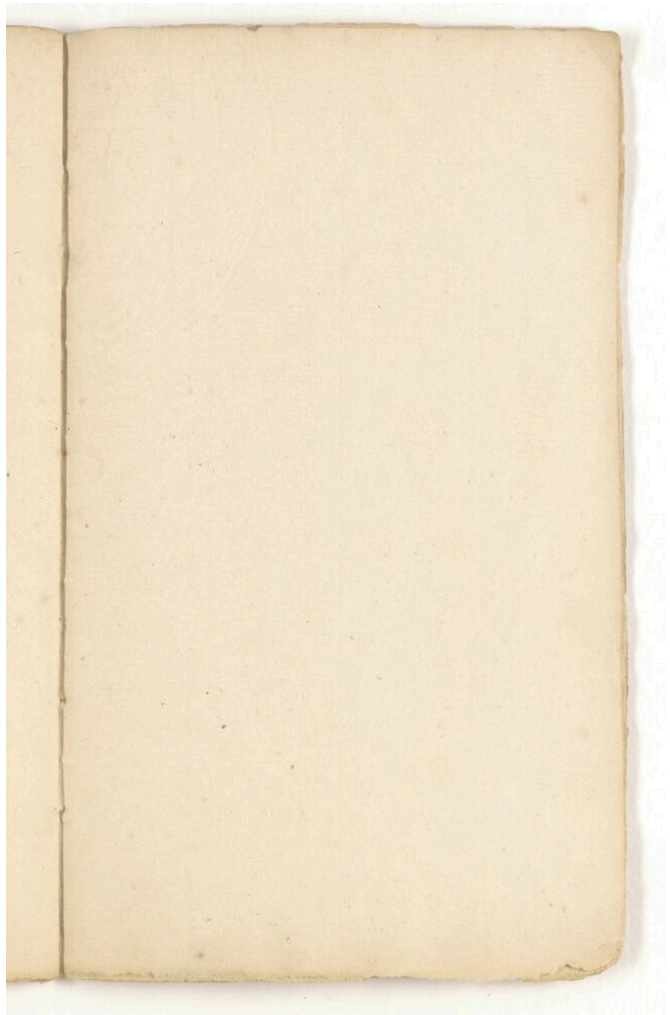
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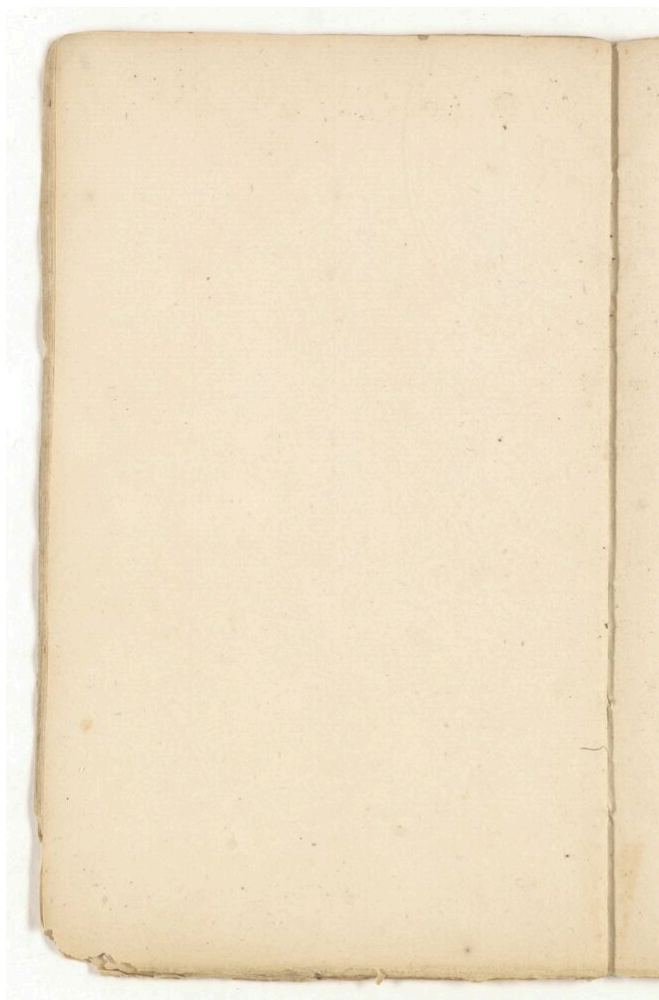
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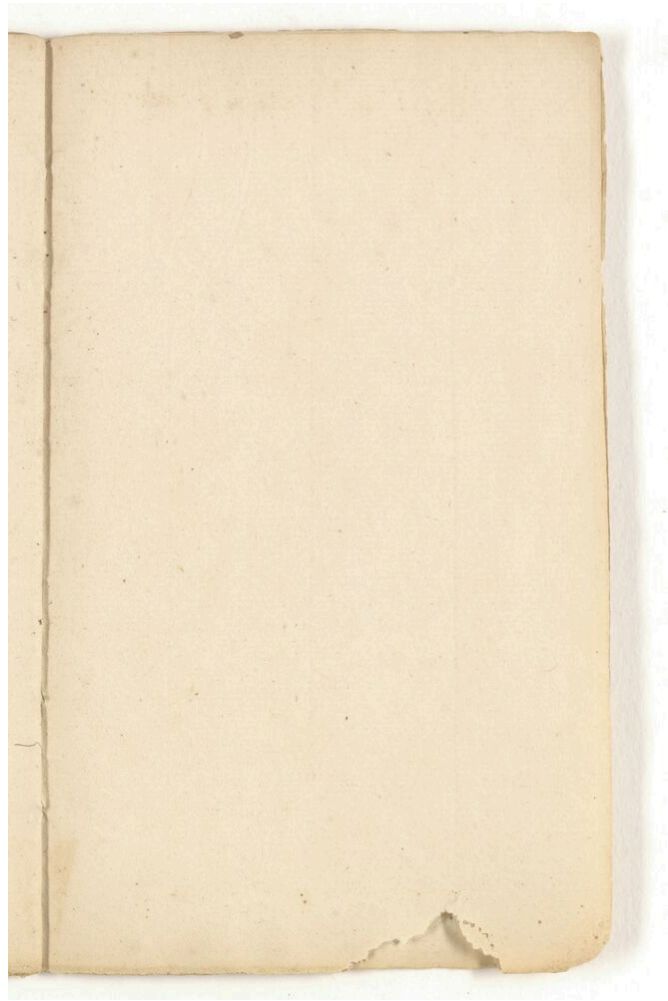
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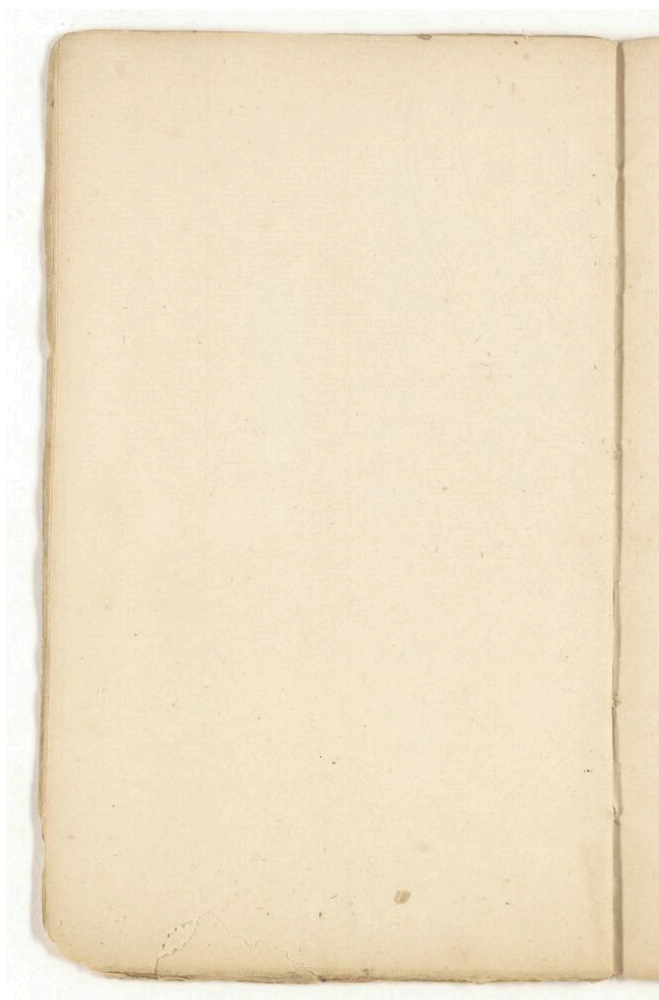
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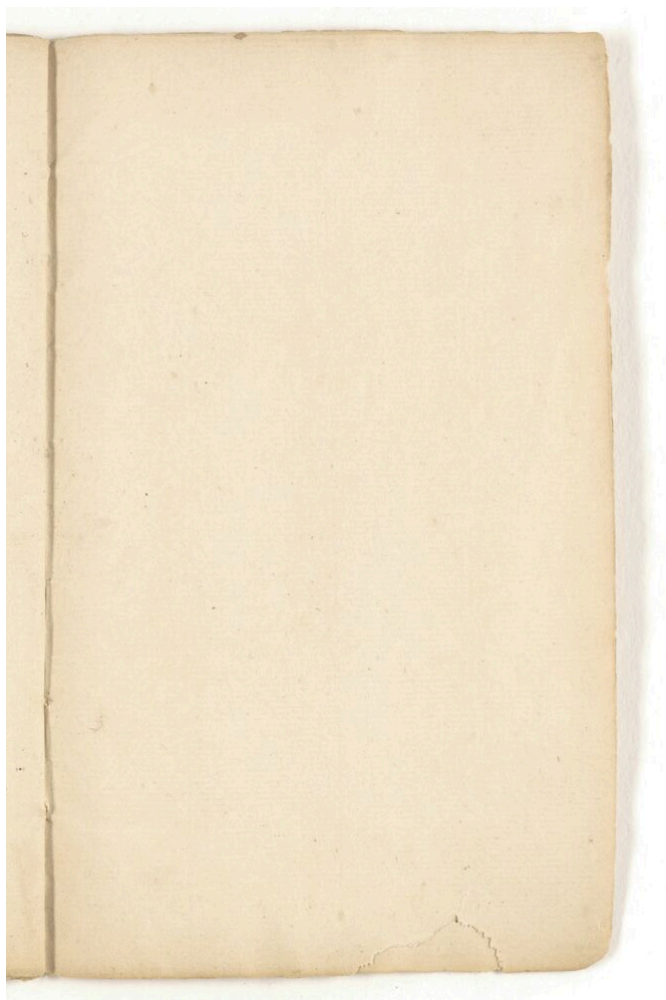
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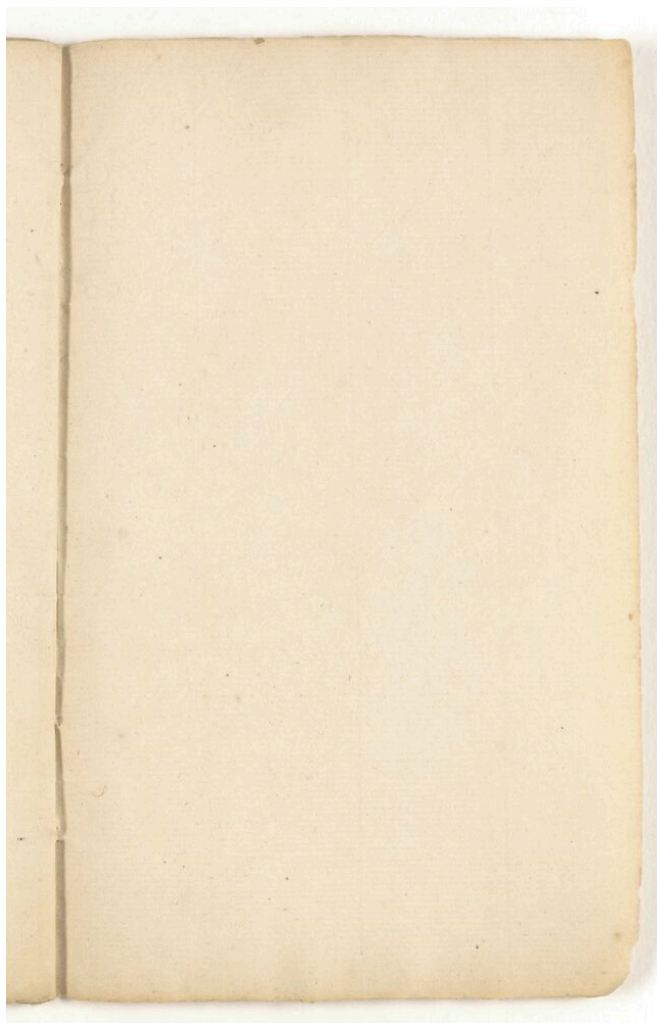
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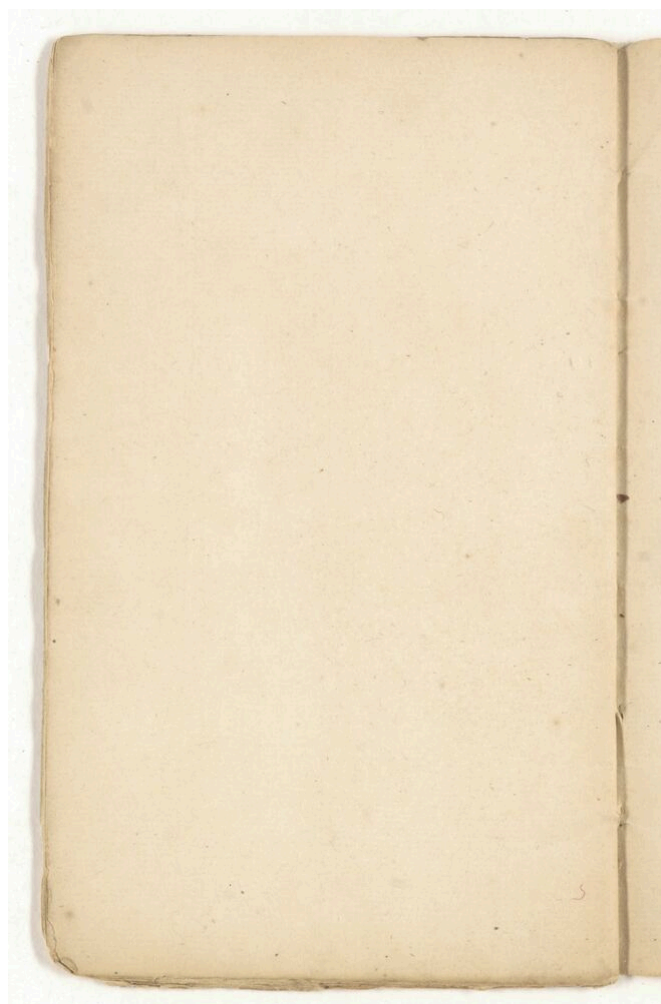
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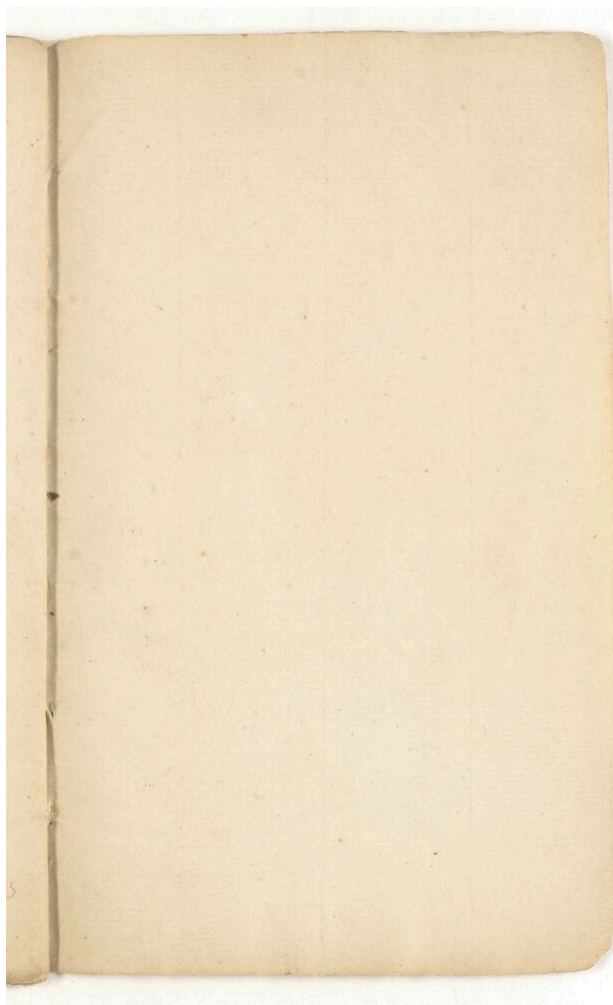
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